

How do annual members and casual riders use Cyclistic bikes differently?

Findings and recommendations for the membership conversion campaign

Stuart Hibberd · Marketing analytics · 5,769,995 rides, July 2025 to June 2026

The task

Finance analysis says annual members are more profitable than casual riders. The director of marketing wants to convert casual riders into members, but the team does not know how the two groups use the service differently.

My job: measure the differences in the most recent complete 12 months of trip data, so the campaign can be designed around real behaviour.

12 months

July 2025 to June 2026, the latest complete period

BigQuery

5,932,349 raw records cleaned to 5,769,995 with every step documented

Tableau

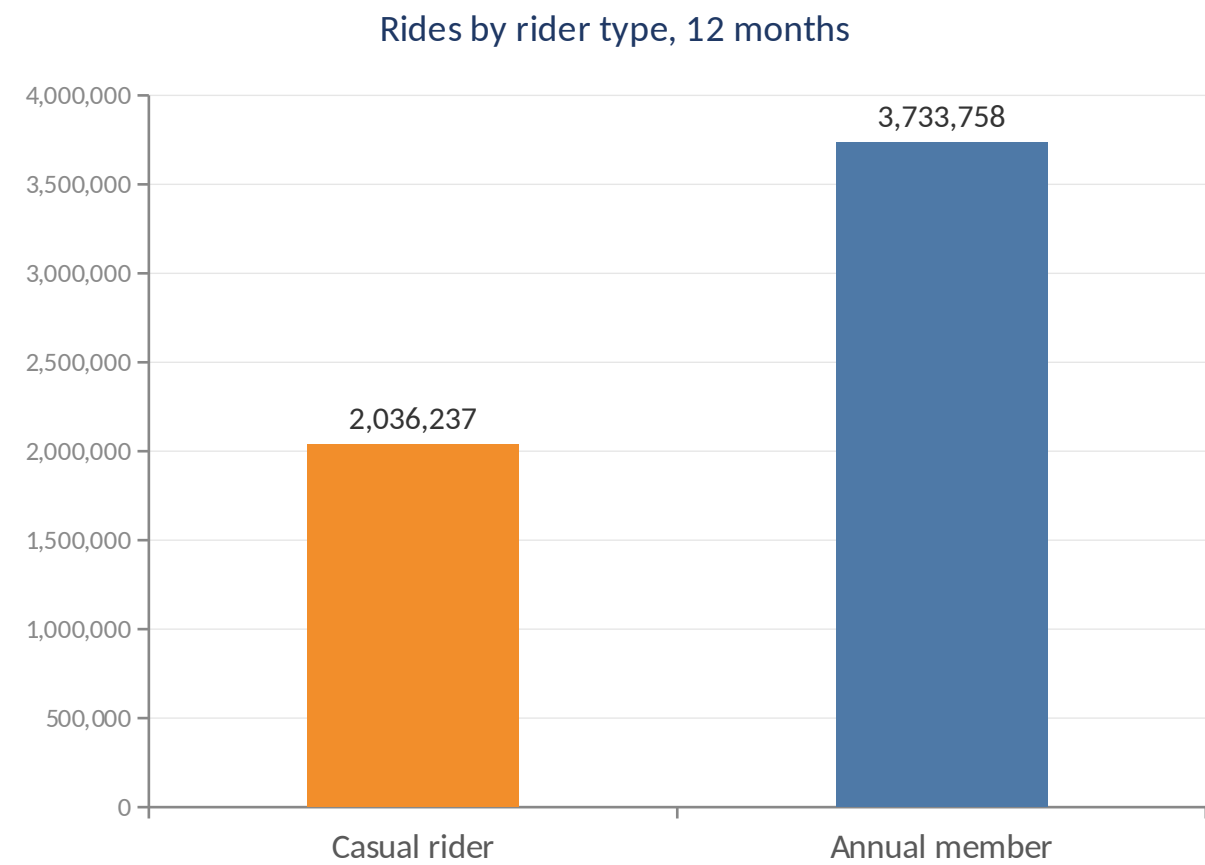
published dashboards carry the full charts

Rides, not riders

no rider identifier exists, so every figure counts rides

The campaign question behind it: where, when and with what message to reach casual riders.

Members ride more, casual rides run longer



64.71%

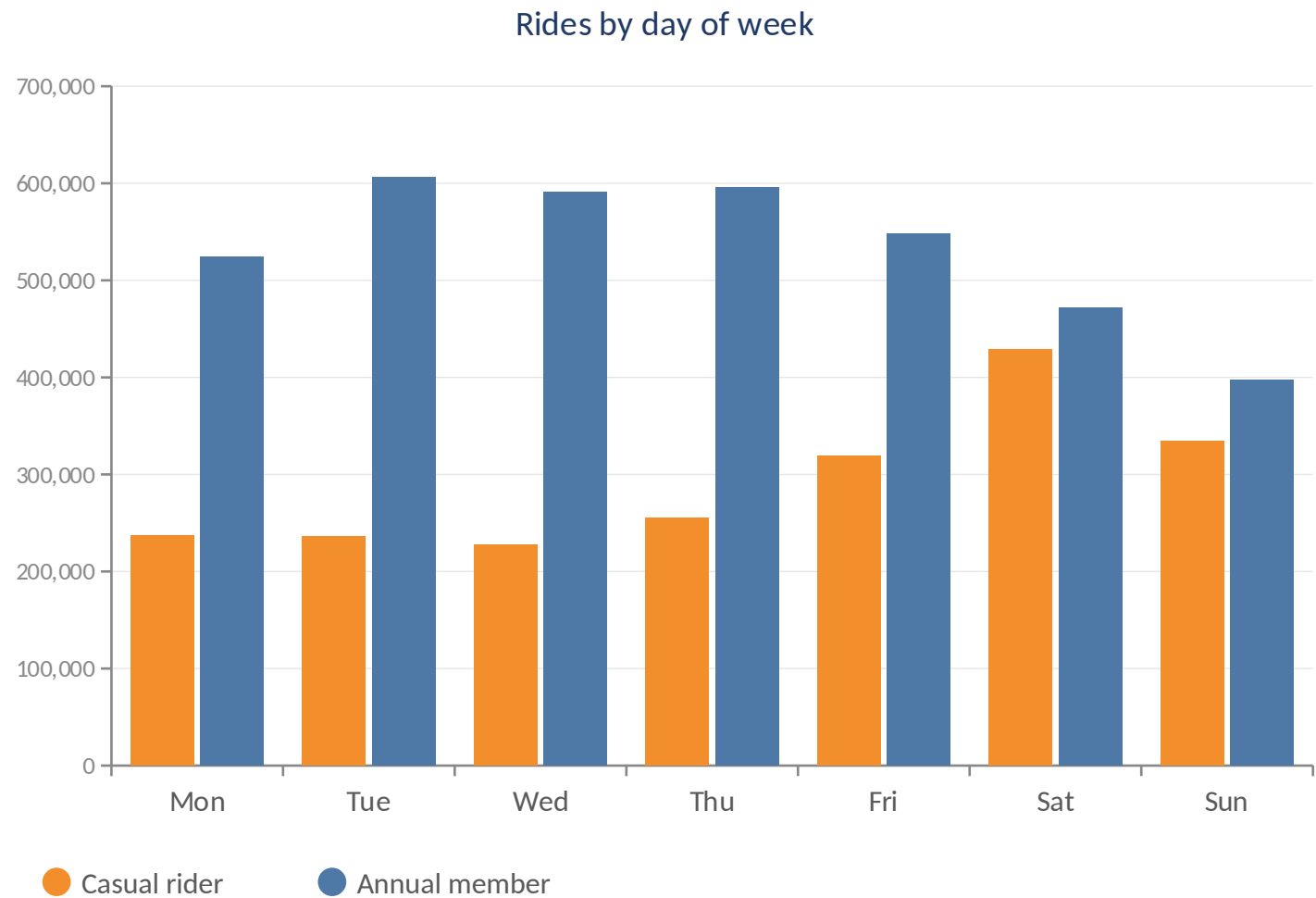
of all rides are member rides

11.63 min

median casual ride, against 8.75 for members. About a third longer

Median used because duration is skewed by a small number of very long rides.

Casual riding peaks at weekends, member riding on weekdays



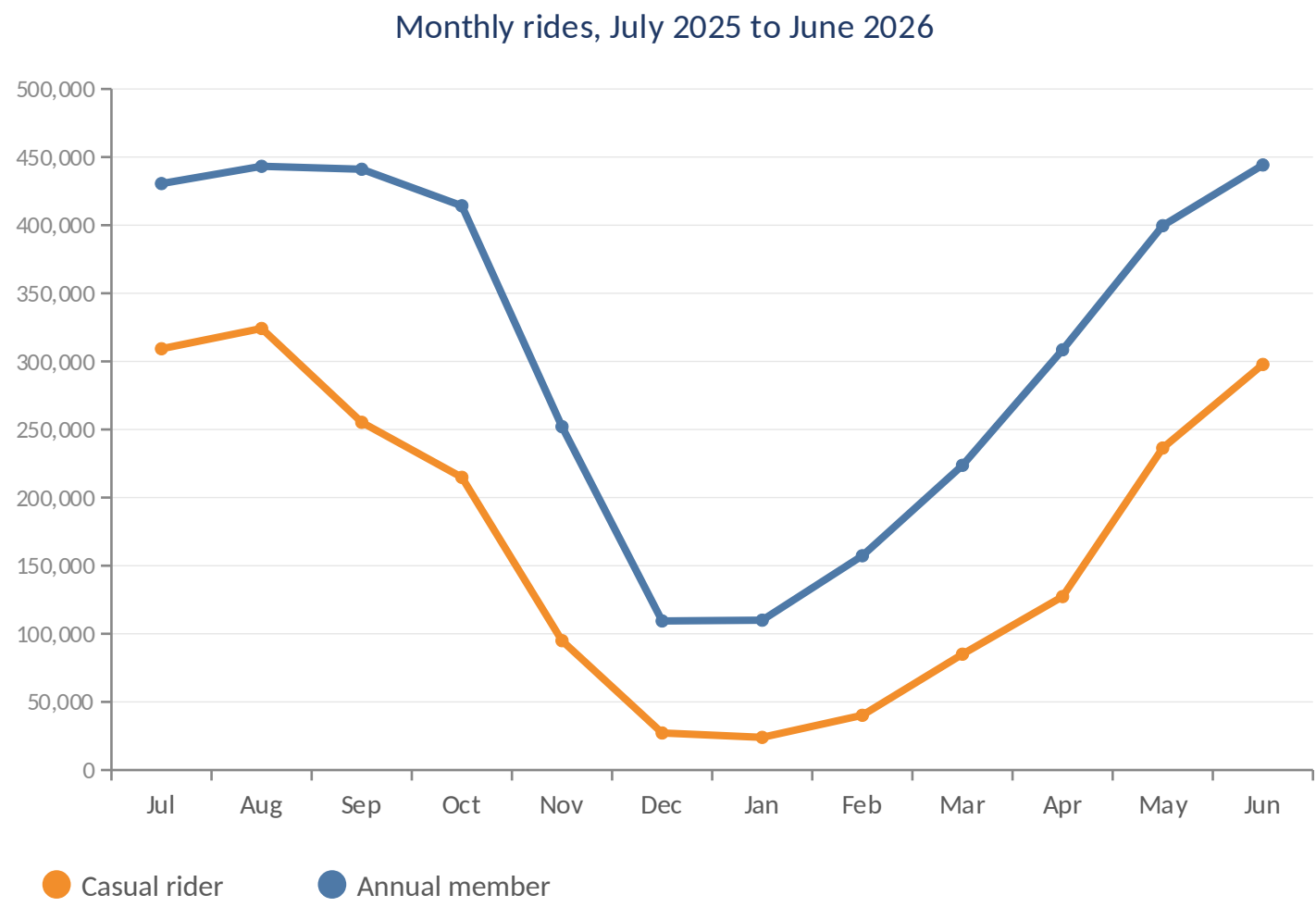
37.4%

of casual riding falls on Saturday or Sunday, against 23.3% of member riding. No day preference would be 28.6%.

8 am and 5 pm

are the member peaks within the day, consistent with commute-time use. Casual riding builds through the day and is strongest from midday into the afternoon.

Both groups are seasonal; casual riding swings three times harder



13.5×

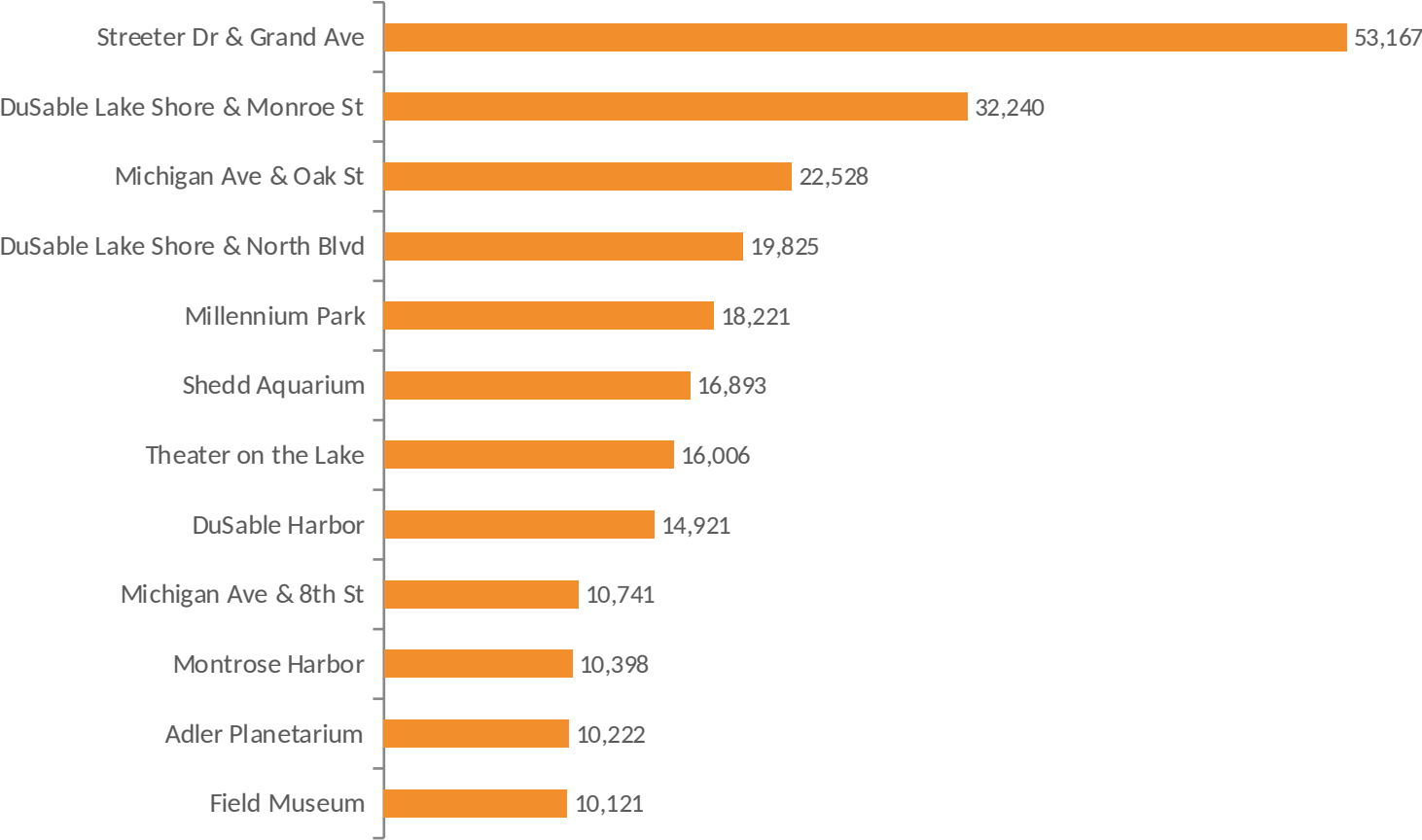
casual swing from August (324,165 rides) to January (23,962). Members swing 4.0× over the same months.

42% → 18%

casual share of all riding, August against January. The customer mix changes with the season, and September already sits at 78.7% of casual's August volume while members hold at 99.5%.

Casual riding clusters on the lakefront and at visitor attractions

Top casual-majority start stations, casual rides



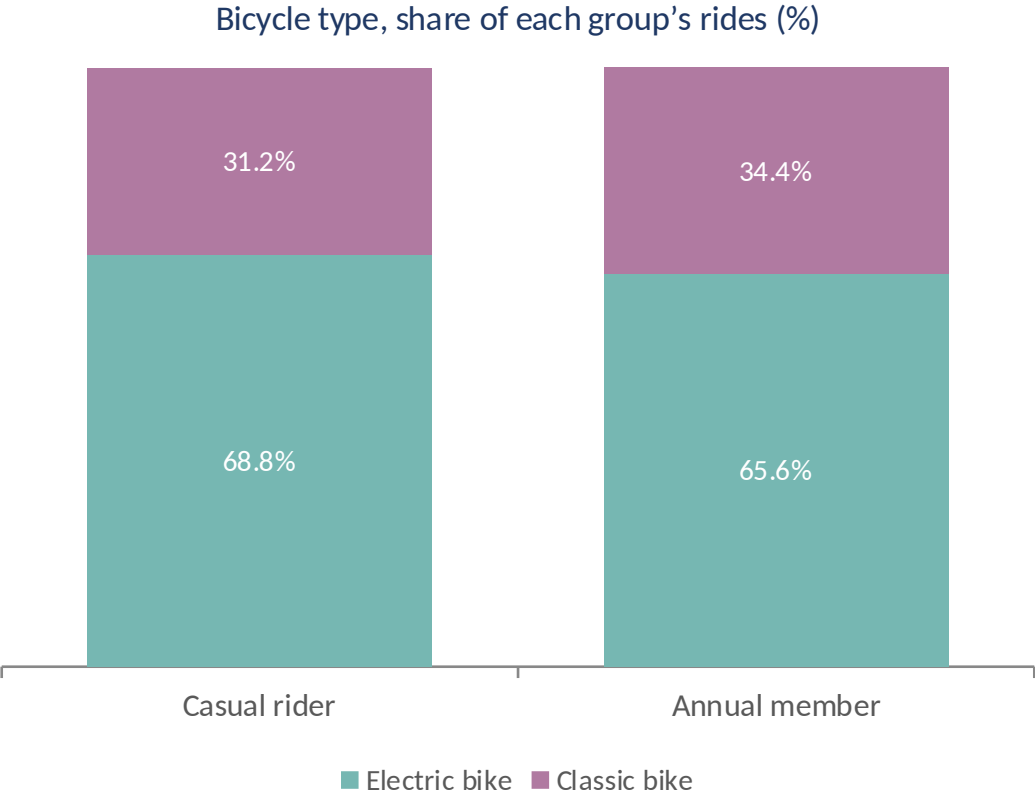
The top casual-majority stations are concentrated around the lakefront, harbour and major visitor areas.

Streeter Dr & Grand Ave alone takes 53,167 casual starts, 77% of its traffic.

Casual use at these stations concentrates from midday to afternoon.

Caution: the data cannot tell visitors from local riders, so heavy casual traffic here does not automatically mean strong membership prospects.

What the groups share, and what it all means



Reading the patterns together

Casual riding concentrates at weekends, in summer, in longer rides, and around lakefront and attraction stations. Member riding spreads across weekdays, holds steadier through the year, runs shorter, and peaks at each end of the working day.

This is consistent with casual riders using Cyclistic more for recreation and leisure, and members using it more as routine travel. The data does not record trip purpose, so that reading is an interpretation, not a measured finding.

Bicycle choice is a similarity, not a difference. Electric bikes dominate for both groups, so bike type is not a targeting lever.

Three recommendations, each built as a test

The data cannot prove any action will cause conversion, so each recommendation is a test with a measured outcome.

WHERE

Test conversion by station type

Run offers at high-casual-volume attraction stations and at high-casual-volume non-attraction stations. The data cannot tell tourists from locals, so measure conversion separately.

WHEN

Test the shoulder season against the peak

Summer weekends give the greatest reach, but casual riding starts falling away in September while member riding holds. Riders about to stop for winter may be more receptive than riders in mid-August. Run both windows, measure conversion per casual ride.

WHAT

Build messaging on how casual riders actually ride

Longer rides, weekends, midday to afternoon. Emphasise membership value for riders whose repeated casual fares approach the membership price; Cyclistic holds the pricing data to set that threshold. Compare messages and measure.

What this analysis can and cannot say

- The records describe rides, not riders. Repeat use and audience size cannot be measured.
- Trip purpose, demographics and residence are not recorded. Behaviour is measured; motive is inferred.
- Location analysis covers only rides with a recorded station ID.
- Next step for the team: run the station-type test, and collect conversion outcomes so the next analysis can measure what this one could not.

[Full dashboards: public.tableau.com/app/profile/stuart.hibberd/viz/Cyclistic_rider_usage_analysis](https://public.tableau.com/app/profile/stuart.hibberd/viz/Cyclistic_rider_usage_analysis)